

Focused inbox

It is five in the morning. You wake yourself up successfully, one of the biggest challenges to a productive start of the day. Fifteen minutes later, you head to your study, all charged up, ready to get going with your next lesson. And there it is again – papers all over on the desk, and books all around; clutter in your way to the task on which you want to focus. Well, what would you do now? Remove all the papers and books you do not need immediately, and stack them away. That precisely is what Microsoft Outlook has been trying to do automatically for you since 2014 when it comes to emails.

Earlier, Microsoft Outlook used the Clutter folder to filter your email, to help you tackle your important emails quickly. However, using the Clutter folder was like using a closet on the other end of the room. Microsoft Outlook 2019 for Windows, on the other hand, uses a Focused view in the inbox for organising important emails that need your immediate attention.

Outlook stacks the other emails that may be important, but do not require your immediate attention, in the Other view instead of stashing them away. You can get to your other emails with a simple Focused or Other button on top of your inbox. It is as simple as using a switch to see the view you want to see – Focused or Other.

Outlook uses machine learning to understand how you organise your inbox, and soon follows in your footsteps, which means if you have been leaving your emails unread for a while, the software learns to put it away in the Other view. What this also means is that if you cannot wait to open the message from your highschool sweetheart, Outlook learns the importance of the message and the sender of the message, and displays it in the Focused view, so you never miss it.

You can choose to switch on the Focused Inbox if that is what you like. To do so, perform the following steps:

- Go to the **View tab > Show Focused Inbox**.

Of course, you may have to train the machine learning software to act in a certain way. You will probably see, on and off, that some important



Image source: <https://support.microsoft.com>